20 bài mẫu IELTS Writing Task 2 — Government & Politics

Từ và cụm quan trọng được tô màu; cuối mỗi bài là các cụm cần nhớ kèm nghĩa. Điểm do AI chấm, chỉ để tham khảo.

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Opinion

#63 Opinion · 299 từ · AI 7.5

Discuss the role of the internet in promoting free speech.

Not long ago, a handful of newspapers and television channels decided which opinions reached the public, but today anyone with a phone can publish a message to the world. This essay will explain two key ways in which the internet promotes free speech: by giving ordinary people a platform and by making it easier to share information and organise.

First and foremost, the internet gives ordinary people a platform that no one controls. Anyone with a connection can publish opinions, share news and organise with others without needing a newspaper or broadcaster, which helps those whose views are ignored or suppressed. A blogger who posts photographs of illegal logging, for example, can reach thousands of people even if the local newspaper stays silent. In countries where the press is restricted, citizens use social media and messaging apps to report events and debate openly, and minority groups can find audiences that traditional media would not give them. Voices from remote regions can be heard worldwide.

In addition, the internet makes it easier to share information and to organise. Posts and videos can spread to millions in hours, protests and petitions can be arranged quickly, and people with similar concerns can find one another across borders. Encrypted tools also protect journalists and activists. However, the same freedom brings problems. Rumour, harassment and hate speech spread easily, and some governments block websites or monitor users to silence critics. Free speech online therefore needs protection from both abuse and censorship, with clear laws, transparency from platforms and digital skills for users who must decide which sources to trust.

To sum up, the internet promotes free speech by giving everyone a voice and by making information easy to share, although it requires careful safeguards. For these reasons, open access to it should be protected.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **a handful of newspapers and television channels** — một vài tờ báo và kênh truyền hình
- **promotes free speech** — thúc đẩy tự do ngôn luận
- **share information and organise** — chia sẻ thông tin và tổ chức
- **a platform that no one controls** — nền tảng không ai kiểm soát
- **publish opinions, share news and organise** — đăng ý kiến, chia sẻ tin và tổ chức
- **views are ignored or suppressed** — quan điểm bị phớt lờ hoặc bị đàn áp
- **illegal logging** — khai thác gỗ trái phép
- **stays silent** — giữ im lặng
- **the press is restricted** — báo chí bị hạn chế
- **report events and debate openly** — đưa tin sự kiện và tranh luận công khai
- **minority groups** — nhóm thiểu số
- **Voices from remote regions** — tiếng nói từ vùng xa
- **share information** — chia sẻ thông tin
- **organise** — tổ chức
- **spread to millions in hours** — lan tới hàng triệu trong vài giờ
- **petitions can be arranged quickly** — kiến nghị có thể được tổ chức nhanh
- **find one another across borders** — tìm thấy nhau xuyên biên giới
- **Rumour, harassment and hate speech** — tin đồn, quấy rối và ngôn luận thù ghét
- **block websites or monitor users** — chặn trang web hoặc theo dõi người dùng
- **silence critics** — bịt miệng người phê phán
- **transparency from platforms** — sự minh bạch từ các nền tảng
- **open access** — truy cập mở

#76 Opinion · 286 từ · AI 7.0

Discuss how media coverage affects public opinion during elections.

Most voters never meet a candidate and learn about them through newspapers, television and the internet, so media coverage has great power in elections. This essay will explain two key ways in which media coverage affects public opinion during elections: by deciding which issues voters think about, and by shaping how they see candidates.

First and foremost, media coverage decides which issues voters think about and how they see candidates. By choosing what to report, how to frame it and whom to interview, newspapers and broadcasters shape priorities. If the media spend weeks on immigration and little on health care, voters may come to feel that immigration is the main issue, whatever their own concerns. A headline that announces which candidate is ahead, for example, can encourage some voters to follow the winner and others to stay at home. Coverage also affects how voters judge a candidate's personality, since a single mistake that is replayed endlessly can damage a reputation more than years of careful policy work.

In addition, the way in which elections are reported often favours drama over detail. Coverage that treats the campaign as a horse race, focusing on opinion polls and personal conflicts, can crowd out discussion of policy, and partisan outlets may present only one side. However, a diverse media offers corrections. Independent fact-checking, public broadcasters with a duty of balance, and a free press that investigates candidates from all parties help voters to form their own views. Citizens should also compare several sources and be aware that every outlet has its own perspective.

To sum up, media coverage strongly affects public opinion during elections by shaping priorities and images, so diversity and honesty in the media are essential to democracy.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **learn about them through newspapers, television and the internet** — biết về họ qua báo, truyền hình và internet
- **media coverage affects public opinion** — đưa tin của truyền thông ảnh hưởng dư luận
- **shaping how they see candidates** — định hình cách họ nhìn ứng viên
- **decides which issues voters think about** — quyết định vấn đề cử tri nghĩ tới
- **what to report, how to frame it and whom to interview** — đưa tin gì, đóng khung thế nào và phỏng vấn ai
- **shape priorities** — định hình ưu tiên
- **the main issue** — vấn đề chính
- **announces which candidate is ahead** — thông báo ứng viên nào đang dẫn đầu
- **follow the winner** — chạy theo người thắng
- **stay at home** — ở nhà
- **a single mistake that is replayed endlessly** — một sai lầm được phát lại không ngừng
- **damage a reputation** — làm hại danh tiếng
- **favours drama over detail** — thiên về kịch tính hơn chi tiết
- **a horse race** — cuộc đua ngựa
- **opinion polls and personal conflicts** — thăm dò dư luận và xung đột cá nhân
- **crowd out discussion of policy** — lấn át thảo luận chính sách
- **partisan outlets** — các kênh thiên vị đảng phái
- **Independent fact-checking** — kiểm chứng độc lập
- **a duty of balance** — nghĩa vụ cân bằng
- **a free press** — báo chí tự do
- **investigates candidates from all parties** — điều tra ứng viên của mọi đảng
- **compare several sources** — so sánh nhiều nguồn

#136 Opinion · 292 từ · AI 7.5

Discuss how technology influences voting behaviour.

In recent elections, campaigns have been fought as much on phones and laptops as on doorsteps, and technology has changed how people decide whom to vote for. This essay will explain two key ways in which technology influences voting behaviour: by changing how voters get information and by changing how campaigns reach them.

First and foremost, technology shapes how voters learn about candidates. Social media spreads both information and false stories, and online tools make registration and research easier. A student who looks up the policies of every party in a few minutes, for example, is better informed than a voter of fifty years ago who relied on a single newspaper. Websites compare manifestos, fact-checkers examine claims, and live streaming lets voters watch debates wherever they are. However, the same tools can mislead, since search results and feeds may show people only what confirms their opinions, and deliberately false stories can influence undecided voters.

In addition, technology changes how campaigns reach voters. Parties use data to target messages at individuals, based on age, job and interests, so that a voter who receives advertisements aimed at his age, job and neighbourhood, for example, sees a very different campaign from his neighbour. Targeted messages can motivate groups who are normally ignored, but they can also be misleading, since the public cannot easily see or challenge what others are being told. Automated accounts can create the impression of widespread support. Voters therefore need skills to judge sources, and regulators should require campaigns to be transparent about who is paying for advertisements and how data are used.

To sum up, technology influences voting behaviour by changing how people learn about politics and how campaigns persuade them. For these reasons, it deserves both encouragement and careful regulation.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **fought as much on phones and laptops as on doorsteps** — đấu trên điện thoại và laptop nhiều như trước cửa nhà dân
- **influences voting behaviour** — ảnh hưởng hành vi bỏ phiếu
- **how voters get information** — cách cử tri lấy thông tin
- **how campaigns reach them** — cách chiến dịch tiếp cận họ
- **learn about candidates** — tìm hiểu về ứng cử viên
- **spreads both information and false stories** — lan truyền cả thông tin lẫn tin giả
- **registration and research easier** — đăng ký và tìm hiểu dễ hơn
- **the policies of every party** — chính sách của mọi đảng
- **relied on a single newspaper** — chỉ dựa vào một tờ báo
- **compare manifestos** — so sánh cương lĩnh
- **fact-checkers examine claims** — người kiểm chứng sự thật xem xét các tuyên bố
- **live streaming** — phát trực tiếp
- **watch debates** — xem các cuộc tranh luận
- **show people only what confirms their opinions** — chỉ cho người ta thấy điều xác nhận ý kiến của họ
- **undecided voters** — cử tri chưa quyết định
- **target messages at individuals** — nhắm thông điệp tới từng cá nhân
- **age, job and interests** — tuổi, nghề nghiệp và sở thích
- **groups who are normally ignored** — những nhóm thường bị bỏ qua
- **misleading** — gây hiểu lầm
- **Automated accounts** — tài khoản tự động
- **the impression of widespread support** — ấn tượng về sự ủng hộ rộng rãi
- **transparent about who is paying** — minh bạch về ai đang trả tiền

#378 Opinion · 291 từ · AI 7.0

Discuss how language policy can affect national unity.

Many countries are home to several languages, and governments must decide which to use in schools, courts and official documents. This essay will explain two key ways in which language policy can affect national unity: by helping people to communicate and share opportunities, and by affecting how minority groups feel about their place in the nation.

First and foremost, a shared language can unite a country, but forcing it can divide. A common language gives everyone access to education, jobs and public services, and it makes it easier for people from different regions to understand one another and to take part in national debates. In a country where citizens speak several languages and cannot communicate, the lack of a common tongue may create separate communities that know little about each other. A national language taught in all schools, for example, lets a young person from a remote village apply for a job in the capital. Shared language can also be a symbol of belonging.

In addition, language policy affects how minority groups feel. Suppressing minority languages makes people feel that their identity is threatened, and may produce resentment and even separatist movements. A region whose road signs and schools use both the national and the local language, for example, lets residents feel that their culture is respected. Evidence from countries with several official languages suggests that bilingual policies can maintain unity while keeping diversity. However, they require resources for teachers, translators and materials. Governments should therefore promote a common language while protecting others, so that all citizens feel valued.

To sum up, language policy can strengthen or weaken national unity depending on whether it respects diversity as well as promoting shared communication. For these reasons, policies should be designed with care.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **home to several languages** — có nhiều ngôn ngữ
- **schools, courts and official documents** — trường học, toà án và văn bản chính thức
- **language policy** — chính sách ngôn ngữ
- **national unity** — sự thống nhất quốc gia
- **helping people to communicate and share opportunities** — giúp mọi người giao tiếp và chia sẻ cơ hội
- **minority groups** — nhóm thiểu số
- **a shared language can unite a country** — ngôn ngữ chung có thể đoàn kết một đất nước
- **forcing it can divide** — ép buộc nó có thể chia rẽ
- **access to education, jobs and public services** — tiếp cận giáo dục, việc làm và dịch vụ công
- **understand one another** — hiểu nhau
- **take part in national debates** — tham gia tranh luận quốc gia
- **separate communities that know little about each other** — những cộng đồng riêng biệt ít hiểu nhau
- **a remote village** — một ngôi làng xa xôi
- **a symbol of belonging** — biểu tượng của sự thuộc về
- **Suppressing minority languages** — dập tắt ngôn ngữ thiểu số
- **identity is threatened** — bản sắc bị đe doạ
- **resentment and even separatist movements** — sự bực bội và thậm chí các phong trào ly khai
- **road signs and schools use both** — biển báo và trường học dùng cả hai
- **teachers, translators and materials** — giáo viên, phiên dịch và tài liệu
- **feel valued** — cảm thấy được trân trọng
- **respects diversity** — tôn trọng sự đa dạng

#492 Opinion · 282 từ · AI 7.5

Discuss the role of technology in improving free speech.

Mobile phones, social media and translation tools have changed how people speak out, and technology is often described as a friend of free speech. This essay will outline two key ways in which technology improves free speech: by widening access and by protecting those who speak.

First and foremost, technology widens access to speech and to audiences. Cheap smartphones, video platforms and blogs give ordinary people a platform that no one controls, so a farmer, a student or a nurse can describe what is happening in their community. Translation tools allow messages to cross language barriers, and live streaming lets witnesses show events as they happen. A student who films an incident and posts it online, for example, may expose abuse that official media would never mention. Because a single post can reach thousands, groups that were once ignored can now organise petitions and campaigns.

In addition, technology can protect people who speak. Encrypted messaging allows journalists, activists and ordinary citizens to communicate safely under hostile regimes, and tools that hide identity help whistleblowers to share evidence without being traced. Archives and cloud storage keep records safe even if an authority tries to delete them. However, technology also creates new threats. Governments use filtering, facial recognition and spyware to monitor critics, and platforms can silence voices through automated moderation or opaque rules. Online abuse can force people into silence. Technology therefore improves free speech only when it is accompanied by privacy laws, open rules for platforms and independent courts.

To sum up, technology improves free speech by widening access and offering protection, provided that it is governed by fair laws. For these reasons, the right to use secure technology should be defended.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Mobile phones, social media and translation tools** — điện thoại, mạng xã hội và công cụ dịch
- **speak out** — lên tiếng
- **a friend of free speech** — người bạn của tự do ngôn luận
- **widening access** — mở rộng tiếp cận
- **protecting those who speak** — bảo vệ người lên tiếng
- **Cheap smartphones, video platforms and blogs** — điện thoại giá rẻ, nền tảng video và blog
- **a platform that no one controls** — nền tảng không ai kiểm soát
- **describe what is happening in their community** — mô tả điều đang xảy ra trong cộng đồng
- **cross language barriers** — vượt rào cản ngôn ngữ
- **live streaming** — phát trực tiếp
- **witnesses show events as they happen** — nhân chứng cho thấy sự việc khi nó diễn ra
- **expose abuse** — phơi bày lạm dụng
- **official media** — truyền thông chính thức
- **organise petitions and campaigns** — tổ chức kiến nghị và chiến dịch
- **Encrypted messaging** — nhắn tin mã hoá
- **under hostile regimes** — dưới chế độ thù địch
- **share evidence without being traced** — chia sẻ bằng chứng mà không bị truy vết
- **filtering, facial recognition and spyware** — bộ lọc, nhận diện khuôn mặt và phần mềm gián điệp
- **automated moderation or opaque rules** — kiểm duyệt tự động hoặc quy tắc mờ ám
- **force people into silence** — buộc người ta im lặng
- **privacy laws** — luật quyền riêng tư

Agree / Disagree

#67 Agree / Disagree · 281 từ · AI 7.5

Many people say that migration benefits the host country. Do you agree or disagree? Give reasons and examples.

Millions of people move to other countries every year to work, study or escape danger, and many people say that migration benefits the host country. I agree with this view, since migrants fill gaps in the workforce and contribute to the economy and culture, although the benefits depend on good planning.

To begin with, migrants fill gaps in the workforce and contribute to the economy. They work in hospitals, farms, construction and technology where employers cannot find enough staff, pay taxes, start businesses and help ageing countries to keep their workforce. A hospital that depends on nurses from abroad, for example, would struggle to keep its wards open without them. Studies in several countries have shown that immigrants often take jobs that local people are unwilling or unable to do, and they spend money, which creates demand for goods and services. Skilled migrants also bring knowledge and links with other countries that help trade and innovation.

Furthermore, migration enriches society. New foods, languages and ideas increase diversity and creativity, and contact between cultures can reduce prejudice. However, migration brings challenges that need planning. Housing, schools and health services may come under pressure in areas where many newcomers settle, wages for some low-paid local workers may be affected, and integration is difficult if newcomers do not speak the language or face discrimination. These problems are manageable if governments invest in services, offer language classes, recognise foreign qualifications and enforce laws against discrimination. Well-managed migration benefits both newcomers and residents, while neglect can cause resentment.

In conclusion, I agree that migration benefits the host country, because it fills workforce gaps and enriches society, provided that it is managed with proper support for integration.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **move to other countries every year** — chuyển sang nước khác mỗi năm
- **work, study or escape danger** — làm việc, học tập hoặc tránh nguy hiểm
- **migration benefits the host country** — di cư có lợi cho nước nhận
- **fill gaps in the workforce** — lấp chỗ trống trong lực lượng lao động
- **hospitals, farms, construction and technology** — bệnh viện, nông trại, xây dựng và công nghệ
- **cannot find enough staff** — không tìm đủ nhân viên
- **pay taxes, start businesses** — đóng thuế, lập doanh nghiệp
- **keep their workforce** — giữ lực lượng lao động
- **nurses from abroad** — y tá từ nước ngoài
- **keep its wards open** — giữ các khoa hoạt động
- **unwilling or unable to do** — không muốn hoặc không thể làm
- **links with other countries** — mối liên hệ với các nước khác
- **enriches society** — làm giàu xã hội
- **diversity and creativity** — đa dạng và sáng tạo
- **reduce prejudice** — giảm định kiến
- **come under pressure** — chịu áp lực
- **wages for some low-paid local workers** — lương của một số lao động địa phương thấp
- **recognise foreign qualifications** — công nhận bằng cấp nước ngoài
- **proper support for integration** — hỗ trợ hoà nhập đúng mức

#106 Agree / Disagree · 270 từ · AI 7.5

To what extent do you agree or disagree that social media increases political awareness?

Politicians now post on social media every day, and some people believe that these platforms make citizens more politically aware. I largely agree, since they make information faster and easier to share, although awareness does not always mean understanding.

To begin with, social media makes political information faster, cheaper and easier to share. News, debates and campaign messages reach young people who rarely read newspapers, and ordinary citizens can question politicians directly. A student who sees a politician's speech shared by friends, for example, may follow the story further, although she may also see only views that she already agrees with. Hashtags and live videos bring attention to issues that traditional media might ignore, and campaigns on topics such as climate change or equality have reached millions. Participation has risen in several countries as young voters learn about elections and registration deadlines online.

Furthermore, social media allows people to discuss politics and to organise. Online communities help citizens to find others who share their concerns and to join petitions and demonstrations. However, awareness is not always understanding. Algorithms tend to show people content that confirms their existing views, creating echo chambers, and false stories can spread faster than corrections. Engagement may also be shallow, such as pressing a like button rather than taking action. To get the full benefit, users should compare several sources, schools should teach media literacy, and platforms should be more transparent about how they rank content.

In conclusion, social media increases political awareness to a large extent by making information accessible, but its benefits depend on users and platforms ensuring that it is accurate and balanced.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **post on social media every day** — đăng bài trên mạng xã hội mỗi ngày
- **politically aware** — có hiểu biết chính trị
- **faster, cheaper and easier to share** — nhanh hơn, rẻ hơn và dễ chia sẻ hơn
- **campaign messages** — thông điệp vận động
- **rarely read newspapers** — hiếm khi đọc báo
- **question politicians directly** — hỏi thẳng chính trị gia
- **follow the story further** — theo dõi câu chuyện sâu hơn
- **views that she already agrees with** — quan điểm mà cô ấy đã đồng tình
- **Hashtags and live videos** — hashtag và video trực tiếp
- **traditional media might ignore** — truyền thông truyền thống có thể bỏ qua
- **climate change or equality** — biến đổi khí hậu hoặc bình đẳng
- **participation** — sự tham gia
- **registration deadlines** — hạn đăng ký
- **organise** — tổ chức
- **share their concerns** — chia sẻ mối quan tâm
- **join petitions and demonstrations** — tham gia kiến nghị và biểu tình
- **awareness is not always understanding** — nhận thức không phải lúc nào cũng là hiểu biết
- **Algorithms** — thuật toán
- **confirms their existing views** — xác nhận quan điểm sẵn có
- **echo chambers** — buồng vang
- **spread faster than corrections** — lan nhanh hơn đính chính
- **compare several sources** — so sánh nhiều nguồn
- **media literacy** — kiến thức truyền thông
- **to a large extent** — ở mức độ lớn

#226 Agree / Disagree · 294 từ · AI 8.0

To what extent do you agree or disagree that voting should be compulsory?

In some countries, citizens who do not vote are fined, and some people argue that voting should be compulsory. I disagree with this view, since compelling people to vote treats a right as a duty and may produce uninformed choices, although I would like turnout to be high.

To begin with, compelling people to vote treats a right as a duty and may produce uninformed choices. Citizens who are forced to attend a polling station may vote randomly or leave the paper blank, resent the state and lose the sense that voting is a free expression of opinion. A person who dislikes every candidate but must still go to the polling station, for example, may simply tick a name at random. Such votes do not make the result more representative, and they may favour candidates whose names are more familiar. In a free society, the right to take part in politics should include the right to choose not to take part, as with other freedoms such as speech and religion.

Furthermore, compulsion treats the symptom, not the cause. Low turnout usually reflects distrust, dissatisfaction with the choice offered or practical difficulties, and forcing people to vote does not address these problems. Supporters point out that compulsory voting increases turnout and makes governments more representative, as in Australia, where participation is very high. That is a real advantage. However, the same result can be achieved by making voting easier and more meaningful through weekend elections, early and postal voting, better civic education and more responsive politics. Fines also fall hardest on those with the least money.

In conclusion, I disagree that voting should be compulsory, because it limits freedom and produces uninformed votes, and the focus should be on making participation easier and more attractive.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **citizens who do not vote are fined** — công dân không đi bỏ phiếu bị phạt
- **voting should be compulsory** — bỏ phiếu nên bắt buộc
- **treats a right as a duty** — coi một quyền như một nghĩa vụ
- **produce uninformed choices** — tạo ra lựa chọn thiếu hiểu biết
- **forced to attend a polling station** — bị buộc đến điểm bỏ phiếu
- **leave the paper blank** — để phiếu trắng
- **resent the state** — bực bội với nhà nước
- **a free expression of opinion** — sự biểu đạt tự do của ý kiến
- **dislikes every candidate** — không thích mọi ứng viên
- **tick a name at random** — đánh dấu một cái tên ngẫu nhiên
- **more representative** — đại diện hơn
- **the right to choose not to take part** — quyền chọn không tham gia
- **compulsion** — sự bắt buộc
- **treats the symptom, not the cause** — chữa triệu chứng chứ không phải nguyên nhân
- **distrust, dissatisfaction with the choice offered** — mất lòng tin, không hài lòng với lựa chọn được đưa ra
- **practical difficulties** — khó khăn thực tế
- **increases turnout** — tăng tỷ lệ cử tri đi bầu
- **participation is very high** — tỷ lệ tham gia rất cao
- **weekend elections, early and postal voting** — bầu cử cuối tuần, bỏ phiếu sớm và qua bưu điện
- **more responsive politics** — nền chính trị đáp ứng tốt hơn
- **fall hardest on those with the least money** — đè nặng nhất lên người ít tiền nhất
- **participation** — sự tham gia

#397 Agree / Disagree · 293 từ · AI 8.0

Some believe that compulsory military service benefits society. To what extent do you agree or disagree?

Some countries require young adults to spend a year or more in the armed forces, and some believe that compulsory military service benefits society. I agree only to a limited extent, since it can teach discipline and bring citizens together, although it has serious costs and professional forces are often more effective.

To begin with, compulsory service can teach discipline and bring citizens from different backgrounds together. Recruits learn teamwork, fitness and practical skills and meet people they would never otherwise meet. A recruit from a farming village sharing a barracks with a student from the capital, for example, learns about a very different way of life, which may reduce prejudice and strengthen national feeling. Service can also give young people who are drifting a sense of direction and training in trades such as mechanics or first aid. In countries facing real military threats, a large trained reserve provides security.

However, the costs are significant. Recruits lose time for study and work, and many do not want to be there, which can reduce morale and make forces less effective than smaller professional armies that are well trained and motivated. Compulsion limits personal freedom, and some people object on grounds of conscience. Unequal treatment of men and women, or of rich and poor who find ways to avoid service, can create resentment. If the aim is to build skills and community, other forms of national service, such as volunteering in hospitals or environmental projects, may bring similar benefits without the need to carry weapons. Governments should therefore weigh benefits against costs carefully.

In conclusion, compulsory military service benefits society only to a limited extent, because the advantages of discipline and social mixing are outweighed in many countries by the costs and by better alternatives.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **spend a year or more in the armed forces** — phục vụ trong lực lượng vũ trang một năm trở lên
- **compulsory military service** — nghĩa vụ quân sự bắt buộc
- **benefits society** — có lợi cho xã hội
- **to a limited extent** — ở mức độ hạn chế
- **teach discipline** — dạy kỷ luật
- **bring citizens from different backgrounds together** — đưa công dân từ các xuất thân khác nhau lại gần nhau
- **teamwork, fitness and practical skills** — làm việc nhóm, thể lực và kỹ năng thực tế
- **meet people they would never otherwise meet** — gặp những người họ sẽ không bao giờ gặp
- **a farming village** — một làng nông nghiệp
- **a very different way of life** — lối sống rất khác
- **reduce prejudice** — giảm định kiến
- **strengthen national feeling** — củng cố tinh thần quốc gia
- **drifting** — lạc hướng
- **a sense of direction** — cảm giác có định hướng
- **first aid** — sơ cứu
- **real military threats** — mối đe doạ quân sự thực sự
- **a large trained reserve** — lực lượng dự bị lớn được huấn luyện
- **lose time for study and work** — mất thời gian học tập và làm việc
- **reduce morale** — giảm tinh thần
- **smaller professional armies** — quân đội chuyên nghiệp nhỏ hơn
- **well trained** — được đào tạo tốt
- **compulsion** — sự bắt buộc
- **limits personal freedom** — hạn chế tự do cá nhân
- **object on grounds of conscience** — phản đối vì lương tâm
- **national service** — nghĩa vụ quốc gia
- **volunteering in hospitals or environmental projects** — làm tình nguyện ở bệnh viện hoặc dự án môi trường

#416 Agree / Disagree · 295 từ · AI 7.5

Many people think that youth activism is important for social change. Do you agree? Explain with examples.

From climate strikes to campaigns for equality, young people are leading many protest movements, and many people think that youth activism is important for social change. I agree with this view, since young people bring energy, fresh ideas and a long-term stake, although their impact depends on how well they work with others.

To begin with, young people bring energy, fresh ideas and a long-term stake to social change. They will live with the consequences of today's decisions on climate, housing and jobs, they are skilled at using social media, and they often challenge habits that older generations accept. Students who leave lessons to demand action on climate change, for example, can put the issue on the front page of newspapers and force politicians to respond. Young people are also less tied to existing institutions and interests, so they are more willing to suggest bold solutions. Many past reforms, from student movements against war to campaigns for civil rights, began with the energy of the young.

Furthermore, activism teaches young people civic skills that last a lifetime, such as organising, debating and cooperating, and many activists later become community leaders or politicians. However, activism has limits. Young people may lack experience of how laws are made, and online campaigns can be shallow, with likes and shares that do not lead to action. Movements can fade when attention moves on. Their impact is greatest when they work with experienced organisations, build clear demands and keep their efforts going over time, and when adults listen to them seriously. Schools and governments can help by creating youth councils and consultations.

In conclusion, I agree that youth activism is important for social change, because young people bring energy and ideas, provided that their efforts are sustained and taken seriously.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **climate strikes** — đình công vì khí hậu
- **youth activism** — hoạt động của thanh niên
- **important for social change** — quan trọng cho thay đổi xã hội
- **bring energy, fresh ideas and a long-term stake** — mang năng lượng, ý tưởng mới và lợi ích dài hạn
- **live with the consequences** — sống với hậu quả
- **climate, housing and jobs** — khí hậu, nhà ở và việc làm
- **skilled at using social media** — giỏi dùng mạng xã hội
- **challenge habits that older generations accept** — thách thức thói quen mà thế hệ lớn tuổi chấp nhận
- **leave lessons to demand action** — bỏ lớp để đòi hành động
- **front page of newspapers** — trang nhất của báo
- **force politicians to respond** — buộc chính trị gia phải đáp lại
- **less tied to existing institutions** — ít bị ràng buộc với thể chế hiện có
- **bold solutions** — giải pháp táo bạo
- **civic skills that last a lifetime** — kỹ năng công dân kéo dài suốt đời
- **organising, debating and cooperating** — tổ chức, tranh luận và hợp tác
- **community leaders or politicians** — lãnh đạo cộng đồng hoặc chính trị gia
- **has limits** — có giới hạn
- **likes and shares that do not lead to action** — lượt thích và chia sẻ không dẫn đến hành động
- **fade when attention moves on** — phai nhạt khi sự chú ý chuyển hướng
- **clear demands** — yêu sách rõ ràng
- **youth councils and consultations** — hội đồng thanh niên và tham vấn
- **taken seriously** — được xem xét nghiêm túc

#457 Agree / Disagree · 308 từ · AI 7.5

Some believe that national service improves civic responsibility. To what extent do you agree or disagree?

In several countries, young people are required or encouraged to give a year of their time to national service, either in the armed forces or in community roles, and some believe that national service improves civic responsibility. I largely agree, since it can teach young people to serve others, although it works only if the service is meaningful.

To begin with, national service can strengthen civic responsibility if it is meaningful. Young people who spend a year helping in hospitals, schools or emergency teams see the needs of their community, learn to cooperate and often keep volunteering afterwards. A school leaver who spends a year helping in a care home, for example, may continue to volunteer for years afterwards, and will understand ageing and illness far better than a person who has never been in such a place. Working with people from different backgrounds also reduces prejudice and builds a sense that citizens depend on one another. Experience of duty teaches that rights come with responsibilities.

Furthermore, service gives young people practical skills and confidence that make them more active citizens, such as teamwork, leadership and problem-solving. Those who take part often feel more connected to their country and more willing to vote, volunteer and take part in public life. However, the effect depends on design. Pointless or forced tasks may create resentment instead, and compulsion may make some young people dislike the idea of service. Programmes should offer real choices between military, social and environmental roles, provide training and recognition, and ensure that those with disabilities or caring duties can take part in suitable ways. Evidence of long-term effects on civic behaviour is still limited, so schemes should be evaluated.

In conclusion, national service improves civic responsibility to a large extent when it is meaningful and offers choice, but poorly designed schemes can have the opposite effect.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **give a year of their time** — dành một năm thời gian của họ
- **national service** — nghĩa vụ quốc gia
- **civic responsibility** — trách nhiệm công dân
- **serve others** — phục vụ người khác
- **only if the service is meaningful** — chỉ khi việc phục vụ có ý nghĩa
- **helping in hospitals, schools or emergency teams** — giúp ở bệnh viện, trường học hoặc đội khẩn cấp
- **see the needs of their community** — thấy nhu cầu của cộng đồng
- **keep volunteering afterwards** — tiếp tục làm tình nguyện sau đó
- **a school leaver** — người vừa rời trường
- **a care home** — nhà dưỡng lão
- **understand ageing and illness** — hiểu về tuổi già và bệnh tật
- **from different backgrounds** — từ các xuất thân khác nhau
- **citizens depend on one another** — công dân phụ thuộc vào nhau
- **rights come with responsibilities** — quyền đi kèm trách nhiệm
- **practical skills** — kỹ năng thực tế
- **teamwork, leadership and problem-solving** — làm việc nhóm, lãnh đạo và giải quyết vấn đề
- **feel more connected to their country** — cảm thấy gắn bó hơn với đất nước
- **take part in public life** — tham gia đời sống công cộng
- **Pointless or forced tasks** — nhiệm vụ vô nghĩa hoặc bị ép buộc
- **compulsion** — sự bắt buộc
- **real choices** — lựa chọn thực sự
- **evaluated** — được đánh giá
- **to a large extent** — ở mức độ lớn

#495 Agree / Disagree · 285 từ · AI 7.5

Some people say that censorship is a waste of time and money. Do you agree or disagree?

Some governments block websites, ban books and control newspapers, and some people say that censorship is a waste of time and money. I largely agree, since broad censorship rarely achieves its aim, although a narrow set of controls can be justified.

To begin with, broad censorship wastes money and rarely achieves its aim. Determined people find ways around blocks, officials must spend large sums on monitoring, and hiding information damages public trust. A blocked website, for example, is often accessible again within hours through a different address or a virtual private network. Banning a book or film often increases curiosity, so that it is read or watched more widely than it would otherwise have been. Large teams of staff and technology are needed to scan content, and mistakes are common, so legitimate information is blocked together with harmful material. The cost could be used for schools or hospitals.

Furthermore, censorship has serious side effects. It stops citizens from learning facts about their own government, hides problems that need to be solved and teaches people to distrust official information. Societies that allow open debate tend to find mistakes earlier and correct them. However, a narrow set of content, such as child abuse, direct incitement to violence and terrorist recruitment, justifies control, because the harm is severe and immediate. Even in these cases, rules should be clear, decisions should be made by courts or independent bodies, and the public should be able to challenge them. Education and media literacy are often more effective than bans in protecting people from harmful or false information.

In conclusion, general censorship is largely a waste of time and money, but carefully targeted restrictions on the most harmful material can be justified.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **block websites, ban books and control newspapers** — chặn trang web, cấm sách và kiểm soát báo chí
- **a waste of time and money** — lãng phí thời gian và tiền
- **broad censorship** — kiểm duyệt rộng
- **rarely achieves its aim** — hiếm khi đạt mục đích
- **find ways around blocks** — tìm cách lách các lệnh chặn
- **spend large sums on monitoring** — chi những khoản lớn cho giám sát
- **damages public trust** — làm hại lòng tin của công chúng
- **a virtual private network** — mạng riêng ảo
- **increases curiosity** — làm tăng sự tò mò
- **scan content** — quét nội dung
- **legitimate information is blocked** — thông tin hợp pháp bị chặn
- **serious side effects** — tác dụng phụ nghiêm trọng
- **learning facts about their own government** — biết sự thật về chính phủ của mình
- **hides problems that need to be solved** — che giấu vấn đề cần giải quyết
- **distrust official information** — không tin thông tin chính thức
- **open debate** — tranh luận công khai
- **child abuse, direct incitement to violence** — lạm dụng trẻ em, kích động bạo lực trực tiếp
- **severe and immediate** — nghiêm trọng và tức thì
- **decisions should be made by courts or independent bodies** — quyết định nên do toà hoặc cơ quan độc lập đưa ra
- **media literacy** — kiến thức truyền thông
- **carefully targeted restrictions** — hạn chế được nhắm mục tiêu cẩn thận

Discuss both views

#231 Discuss both views · 285 từ · AI 8.0

Is it better to focus government spending on emergency services or on prevention programs? Discuss and give your opinion.

Opinions are divided as to whether public money should be spent mainly on emergency services or on prevention programmes. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of emergency services argue that they save lives at the moment when everything else has failed. Fire crews, ambulances and rescue teams reach people in danger within minutes, and some accidents and disasters happen however much prevention is in place. A person who suffers a heart attack, for example, may survive only if an ambulance arrives within minutes. Cutting these services would put lives at immediate risk, and the public expects the state to respond whenever help is needed. Emergency workers also provide reassurance, because people feel safer when they know that help will come quickly. Well-equipped services also deal with events that no prevention could stop, such as earthquakes and sudden illness.

On the other hand, supporters of prevention point out that it stops harm before it happens and costs far less than repairing damage. Safety education, building standards, health screening and crime-prevention programmes reduce the number of emergencies in the first place, and the savings continue year after year. A town that builds flood walls and drains, for example, may avoid damage that would cost far more to repair after every storm. Prevention also reduces suffering that cannot be measured in money, such as injuries, bereavement and lost homes. Preventing a fire is better than extinguishing it.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Personally, I believe that a balanced budget is best: emergency services must be fully funded because they are essential, but a growing share should go to prevention because it reduces the need for emergency help.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **public money** — tiền công
- **emergency services** — dịch vụ khẩn cấp
- **prevention programmes** — chương trình phòng ngừa
- **supporters of emergency services** — người ủng hộ dịch vụ khẩn cấp
- **save lives at the moment when everything else has failed** — cứu mạng vào lúc mọi thứ khác đã thất bại
- **Fire crews, ambulances and rescue teams** — đội cứu hoả, xe cứu thương và đội cứu hộ
- **reach people in danger within minutes** — đến với người gặp nguy trong vài phút
- **however much prevention is in place** — dù có phòng ngừa đến đâu
- **suffers a heart attack** — bị đau tim
- **put lives at immediate risk** — đặt tính mạng vào rủi ro tức thì
- **respond whenever help is needed** — ứng phó bất cứ khi nào cần giúp đỡ
- **provide reassurance** — mang lại sự yên tâm
- **feel safer** — cảm thấy an toàn hơn
- **sudden illness** — bệnh đột ngột
- **stops harm before it happens** — ngăn tác hại trước khi xảy ra
- **costs far less than repairing damage** — tốn ít hơn nhiều so với sửa chữa thiệt hại
- **Safety education, building standards** — giáo dục an toàn, tiêu chuẩn xây dựng
- **health screening** — sàng lọc sức khoẻ
- **the savings continue year after year** — khoản tiết kiệm tiếp diễn hằng năm
- **flood walls and drains** — tường chắn lũ và cống thoát nước
- **injuries, bereavement and lost homes** — thương tích, mất người thân và mất nhà
- **a balanced budget** — ngân sách cân bằng

#347 Discuss both views · 278 từ · AI 7.5

Some people believe that public protests are a vital part of democracy. Others disagree. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

Marches, strikes and sit-ins are familiar parts of political life, and opinions differ on whether public protests are a vital part of democracy. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters argue that peaceful protest lets citizens speak between elections. Marches and demonstrations show politicians how strongly people feel, have helped to win rights such as votes for women and civil rights, and give a voice to groups that are ignored by parties and newspapers. A peaceful march of thousands of people through the capital, for example, shows politicians that an issue cannot be ignored. In a democracy, power belongs to the people, and the freedom to gather and express views openly is itself a basic right. Where protest is banned, governments often grow less accountable, which is why authoritarian regimes fear it so much.

On the other hand, critics point out that protests can cause disruption and sometimes violence. Roads and businesses may be blocked, ordinary people may be harmed, and the small group who take part may not represent the majority. Disruption or violence can also turn public opinion against a cause. In a democracy, there are other channels, such as elections, petitions, courts and elected representatives, through which concerns can be raised and settled by law. Decisions made under the pressure of crowds may not be well considered, and protests can be organised by groups that are well-funded rather than widely supported.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Personally, I believe that peaceful protest is a vital part of democracy, because it gives citizens a voice, provided that it remains lawful and respects the rights of others.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Marches, strikes and sit-ins** — diễu hành, đình công và ngồi biểu tình
- **public protests** — biểu tình công khai
- **a vital part of democracy** — phần thiết yếu của dân chủ
- **peaceful protest** — biểu tình hoà bình
- **speak between elections** — lên tiếng giữa các kỳ bầu cử
- **show politicians how strongly people feel** — cho chính trị gia thấy người dân cảm nhận mạnh thế nào
- **votes for women and civil rights** — quyền bầu cử cho phụ nữ và dân quyền
- **give a voice to groups that are ignored** — cho tiếng nói những nhóm bị phớt lờ
- **cannot be ignored** — không thể bị phớt lờ
- **power belongs to the people** — quyền lực thuộc về người dân
- **the freedom to gather** — tự do tụ tập
- **less accountable** — ít chịu trách nhiệm hơn
- **authoritarian regimes** — các chế độ độc tài
- **critics point out** — người chỉ trích chỉ ra
- **cause disruption and sometimes violence** — gây gián đoạn và đôi khi bạo lực
- **turn public opinion against a cause** — làm dư luận quay lưng với một sự nghiệp
- **other channels** — các kênh khác
- **petitions, courts and elected representatives** — kiến nghị, toà án và đại biểu dân cử
- **pressure of crowds** — áp lực của đám đông
- **lawful and respects the rights of others** — hợp pháp và tôn trọng quyền của người khác

#353 Discuss both views · 279 từ · AI 7.5

Is it better to focus government spending on emergency response or on long-term prevention? Discuss and give your opinion.

Floods, earthquakes and storms cause enormous damage every year, and opinions differ on whether governments should focus on emergency response after a disaster or on long-term prevention. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of emergency response argue that rescue and relief save lives at the moment of greatest need. Search teams, field hospitals, food and shelter must be ready within hours, and when a disaster strikes the public expects an immediate and visible response. A family trapped by floodwater, for example, can only be rescued by trained crews with boats and helicopters, however many defences were planned. Emergency response also protects order, since people who are hungry and without shelter may panic. Some disasters, such as earthquakes, cannot be predicted, so response capacity is always necessary.

On the other hand, supporters of long-term prevention point out that preparing in advance reduces damage and costs far less than repairing it. Flood defences, strict building standards, early warning systems and better land planning mean that fewer people are in danger when a hazard arrives. A town that builds flood walls and drains, for example, may avoid damage that would cost far more to repair after every storm. Climate change is also making disasters more frequent, so investment in resilience becomes increasingly urgent. Money spent on prevention often protects homes, jobs and public services as well as lives, and the benefits continue for decades.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that prevention should receive the larger share of long-term spending, because it reduces losses, while a well-funded emergency response must be maintained for the events that cannot be prevented.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Floods, earthquakes and storms** — lũ lụt, động đất và bão
- **emergency response after a disaster** — ứng phó khẩn cấp sau thiên tai
- **long-term prevention** — phòng ngừa dài hạn
- **rescue and relief** — cứu hộ và cứu trợ
- **the moment of greatest need** — thời điểm cần nhất
- **Search teams, field hospitals, food and shelter** — đội tìm kiếm, bệnh viện dã chiến, thức ăn và nơi trú
- **ready within hours** — sẵn sàng trong vài giờ
- **an immediate and visible response** — phản ứng tức thì và thấy được
- **trapped by floodwater** — kẹt trong nước lũ
- **boats and helicopters** — thuyền và trực thăng
- **protects order** — bảo vệ trật tự
- **cannot be predicted** — không thể dự báo
- **response capacity** — năng lực ứng phó
- **preparing in advance** — chuẩn bị trước
- **reduces damage** — giảm thiệt hại
- **Flood defences, strict building standards** — đê chống lũ, tiêu chuẩn xây dựng nghiêm ngặt
- **early warning systems** — hệ thống cảnh báo sớm
- **better land planning** — quy hoạch đất tốt hơn
- **flood walls and drains** — tường chắn lũ và cống thoát nước
- **more frequent** — thường xuyên hơn
- **investment in resilience** — đầu tư vào khả năng chống chịu
- **increasingly urgent** — ngày càng cấp bách
- **homes, jobs and public services** — nhà cửa, việc làm và dịch vụ công

Causes / Solutions

#262 Causes / Solutions · 285 từ · AI 7.5

How can governments make voting more accessible? Suggest practical measures.

In many democracies, a large share of eligible citizens never vote, and some of them are kept away by practical obstacles such as long queues, strict deadlines and inconvenient hours. This essay will suggest practical measures that governments could take, focusing on making it easier to cast a vote and on making information and registration simpler.

To begin with, governments should remove the practical obstacles that stop people from voting. More polling stations, early and postal voting, weekend or holiday elections, transport for older and disabled voters and automatic registration make it easier to take part. A nurse who works night shifts, for example, can vote during a week of early voting instead of missing the single election day. Longer opening hours and mobile polling stations in rural areas help people who live far from a town. Voting by post or secure online systems can suit people who are away from home, such as students and workers abroad, provided that safeguards against fraud are in place.

In addition, authorities should make registration and information simple. Automatic or same-day registration removes a barrier that stops many young people and those who move home often, and reminders by text message can encourage participation. Clear guides in several languages and plain language help new citizens and people with limited education to understand how to vote. Equally important, polling places should be accessible to wheelchair users, with assistance available for those who are blind or have difficulty reading. Measures like these cost little compared with the democratic benefits, and they help ensure that governments represent the whole population.

In conclusion, widening opportunities to vote and simplifying registration and information offer the most realistic way of making voting more accessible.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **a large share of eligible citizens never vote** — phần lớn công dân đủ điều kiện chưa bao giờ bỏ phiếu
- **practical obstacles** — rào cản thực tế
- **long queues, strict deadlines and inconvenient hours** — hàng chờ dài, hạn chót nghiêm ngặt và giờ bất tiện
- **practical measures** — biện pháp thiết thực
- **cast a vote** — bỏ một lá phiếu
- **remove the practical obstacles** — gỡ bỏ rào cản thực tế
- **More polling stations** — thêm điểm bỏ phiếu
- **early and postal voting** — bỏ phiếu sớm và qua bưu điện
- **weekend or holiday elections** — bầu cử cuối tuần hoặc ngày lễ
- **transport for older and disabled voters** — phương tiện đi lại cho cử tri lớn tuổi và khuyết tật
- **automatic registration** — đăng ký tự động
- **works night shifts** — làm ca đêm
- **mobile polling stations** — điểm bỏ phiếu lưu động
- **safeguards against fraud** — biện pháp phòng chống gian lận
- **same-day registration** — đăng ký cùng ngày
- **move home often** — hay chuyển nhà
- **reminders by text message** — nhắc nhở bằng tin nhắn
- **participation** — sự tham gia
- **plain language** — ngôn ngữ đơn giản
- **accessible to wheelchair users** — dễ tiếp cận cho người dùng xe lăn
- **represent the whole population** — đại diện cho toàn bộ dân cư
- **more accessible** — dễ tiếp cận hơn

#289 Causes / Solutions · 282 từ · AI 7.5

What are the causes of low voter turnout? What solutions can be proposed?

In many democracies, fewer than two-thirds of eligible voters take part in elections, and in some local elections the figure is far lower. This essay will analyse the principal causes and propose realistic solutions.

Low turnout reflects distrust, a feeling that votes do not matter and practical obstacles. Voters who believe that politicians are all the same or that the result will not change their lives see little point in taking part, and registration rules, long queues and working hours make voting inconvenient. A worker who sees a queue of two hours outside the polling station, for example, may decide that his time is better spent elsewhere. In addition, young people and those on low incomes, who often feel ignored by parties, are the least likely to vote, and weak civic education leaves many unsure how the system works or why it matters. As a result, their interests are underrepresented, which increases their sense of exclusion in a damaging cycle.

To address this issue, governments should make voting easier and politics more relevant. Early and postal voting, weekend elections and automatic registration remove practical barriers, while civic education in schools teaches young people how decisions are made and why participation matters. In addition, parties should engage directly with young and poorer communities, and electoral reform, such as more proportional systems, can make votes count more. Greater transparency about money in politics and tougher action against corruption would help to rebuild trust. Campaigns by independent bodies can also remind people of election dates and explain how to vote.

In conclusion, low voter turnout stems mainly from distrust and inconvenience, but easier voting, civic education and more responsive politics offer a realistic way forward.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **fewer than two-thirds of eligible voters** — ít hơn hai phần ba cử tri đủ điều kiện
- **take part in elections** — tham gia bầu cử
- **analyse the principal causes** — phân tích các nguyên nhân chính
- **distrust, a feeling that votes do not matter** — mất lòng tin, cảm giác phiếu bầu không có giá trị
- **practical obstacles** — rào cản thực tế
- **politicians are all the same** — chính trị gia ai cũng như nhau
- **will not change their lives** — sẽ không thay đổi cuộc sống của họ
- **see little point in taking part** — thấy ít ý nghĩa khi tham gia
- **registration rules, long queues and working hours** — quy định đăng ký, hàng chờ dài và giờ làm việc
- **a queue of two hours** — hàng chờ hai giờ
- **on low incomes** — có thu nhập thấp
- **feel ignored by parties** — cảm thấy bị các đảng phớt lờ
- **weak civic education** — giáo dục công dân yếu
- **unsure how the system works** — không chắc hệ thống vận hành thế nào
- **their interests are underrepresented** — lợi ích của họ ít được đại diện
- **early and postal voting** — bỏ phiếu sớm và qua bưu điện
- **automatic registration** — đăng ký tự động
- **civic education in schools** — giáo dục công dân ở trường
- **participation** — sự tham gia
- **more proportional systems** — hệ thống tỷ lệ hơn
- **make votes count more** — làm cho phiếu bầu có giá trị hơn
- **transparency about money in politics** — minh bạch về tiền trong chính trị
- **rebuild trust** — xây dựng lại lòng tin
- **low voter turnout** — tỷ lệ cử tri đi bầu thấp
- **stems mainly from** — chủ yếu bắt nguồn từ
- **more responsive politics** — nền chính trị đáp ứng tốt hơn
- **offer a realistic way forward** — mở ra hướng đi thực tế

#331 Causes / Solutions · 265 từ · AI 7.5

What are the causes of corruption in public office? What solutions can be proposed?

Corruption by officials, from small bribes to large-scale theft of public money, damages development in many countries. This essay will analyse the principal causes of corruption in public office and propose realistic solutions.

Corruption grows where power is unchecked and punishment is weak. Officials with low pay and wide discretion are tempted by bribes, secrecy hides wrongdoing, and a culture that tolerates favours makes it seem normal. An official who is paid very little and controls permits, for example, may be tempted to ask for a bribe to approve an application. In addition, weak courts and poorly supported anti-corruption agencies mean that offenders rarely face punishment, and complicated rules create more opportunities for officials to demand payment for ordinary services. When citizens expect to pay bribes, corruption becomes self-reinforcing, and public money is wasted while trust in government falls.

To address this issue, governments should combine transparency, independent oversight and certain punishment. Open contracts and published budgets expose abuse, independent agencies investigate without fear, fair salaries reduce temptation, and protected whistleblowers make reporting safe. Simplifying procedures and moving services online reduces the face-to-face contact in which bribes are asked for. In addition, courts must be independent, so that powerful people cannot escape punishment, and a free press and education can build a culture that rejects corruption. Reform takes time, but countries that have reduced corruption, by following such steps, have seen public services improve and investment rise.

In conclusion, corruption in public office stems mainly from unchecked power, low pay and weak punishment, but transparency, independent oversight and fair rules offer a realistic way forward.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Corruption by officials** — tham nhũng của quan chức
- **small bribes to large-scale theft of public money** — từ hối lộ nhỏ đến trộm cắp tiền công quy mô lớn
- **analyse the principal causes** — phân tích các nguyên nhân chính
- **corruption in public office** — tham nhũng trong cơ quan công quyền
- **unchecked and punishment is weak** — không được kiểm soát và hình phạt yếu
- **low pay and wide discretion** — lương thấp và quyền tự quyết rộng
- **tempted by bribes** — bị cám dỗ bởi hối lộ
- **secrecy hides wrongdoing** — bí mật che giấu sai phạm
- **tolerates favours** — dung thứ việc nhờ vả
- **controls permits** — kiểm soát giấy phép
- **approve an application** — phê duyệt một đơn
- **weak courts** — toà án yếu kém
- **anti-corruption agencies** — cơ quan chống tham nhũng
- **rarely face punishment** — hiếm khi bị trừng phạt
- **self-reinforcing** — tự củng cố
- **public money** — tiền công
- **trust in government falls** — niềm tin vào chính phủ giảm
- **Open contracts and published budgets expose abuse** — hợp đồng công khai và ngân sách công bố phơi bày lạm dụng
- **independent agencies** — cơ quan độc lập
- **investigate without fear** — điều tra không sợ hãi
- **Fair salaries** — mức lương công bằng
- **reduce temptation** — giảm cám dỗ
- **face-to-face contact** — tiếp xúc trực tiếp
- **escape punishment** — thoát khỏi hình phạt
- **a free press** — báo chí tự do
- **a culture that rejects corruption** — văn hoá bác bỏ tham nhũng
- **public services** — dịch vụ công
- **stems mainly from** — chủ yếu bắt nguồn từ
- **offer a realistic way forward** — mở ra hướng đi thực tế

Extent

#342 Extent · 301 từ · AI 8.0

To what extent should governments control online hate speech? Give reasons for your answer.

Online platforms allow people to insult others about their race, religion or origin in front of millions, and some argue that governments should control online hate speech. I largely agree, since it causes real harm and companies cannot be left to regulate themselves, although controls must be carefully limited.

To begin with, online hate speech causes real harm and should be limited by law. Abuse aimed at a person's race, religion or identity can drive victims offline, spread fear and sometimes lead to violence. A woman who receives hundreds of abusive messages about her religion, for example, may stop speaking in public altogether, which damages free expression rather than protecting it. Hatred spread online has been linked to attacks on minorities in several countries, and young people who see such content may come to accept it as normal. Companies that profit from engagement have little reason to remove content that attracts attention, so they cannot be trusted to regulate themselves.

Furthermore, governments are the only bodies able to set clear, consistent rules and to enforce them across platforms. Laws can require companies to remove illegal content quickly, report seriously dangerous threats and publish information on how they moderate. However, controls have risks. Definitions of hate speech can be vague, and governments may use them to silence criticism or minority opinions. Rules must therefore be narrow and clearly defined, restricted to threats, incitement to violence and abuse that targets people for who they are, with oversight by independent courts and a right of appeal. Education about respectful behaviour online is also important, because laws alone cannot change attitudes.

In conclusion, governments should control online hate speech to a large extent, because it harms people and platforms will not solve the problem themselves, provided that the rules are narrow and protect legitimate debate.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **insult others about their race, religion or origin** — xúc phạm người khác về chủng tộc, tôn giáo hoặc nguồn gốc
- **online hate speech** — ngôn luận thù ghét trực tuyến
- **causes real harm** — gây hại thật sự
- **cannot be left to regulate themselves** — không thể để tự điều chỉnh
- **carefully limited** — được giới hạn cẩn thận
- **Abuse aimed at a person's race, religion or identity** — lăng mạ nhắm vào chủng tộc, tôn giáo hay danh tính của một người
- **drive victims offline** — đẩy nạn nhân ra khỏi mạng
- **spread fear** — gieo rắc sợ hãi
- **lead to violence** — dẫn đến bạo lực
- **stop speaking in public altogether** — ngừng nói trước công chúng hoàn toàn
- **damages free expression rather than protecting it** — làm hại tự do biểu đạt thay vì bảo vệ
- **attacks on minorities** — các vụ tấn công người thiểu số
- **accept it as normal** — chấp nhận nó là bình thường
- **profit from engagement** — kiếm lời từ tương tác
- **clear, consistent rules** — quy tắc rõ ràng, nhất quán
- **remove illegal content quickly** — gỡ nội dung bất hợp pháp nhanh chóng
- **Definitions of hate speech can be vague** — định nghĩa ngôn luận thù ghét có thể mơ hồ
- **silence criticism or minority opinions** — bịt miệng phê phán hoặc ý kiến thiểu số
- **oversight by independent courts and a right of appeal** — giám sát bởi toà độc lập và quyền kháng cáo
- **change attitudes** — thay đổi thái độ
- **to a large extent** — ở mức độ lớn
- **legitimate debate** — tranh luận chính đáng

Advantages / Disadvantages

#439 Advantages / Disadvantages · 300 từ · AI 8.0

What are the benefits for a country that focuses on disaster preparedness? Use examples.

Earthquakes, floods, storms and epidemics can strike any country, and some governments invest heavily in being ready for them. This essay will outline two principal benefits for a country that focuses on disaster preparedness: protection of lives and health, and reduced economic damage and faster recovery.

First and foremost, preparing for disasters saves lives and reduces injuries. Early warning systems, evacuation plans, strict building codes and stored supplies mean that fewer people are hurt and communities recover faster. A country in an earthquake zone that enforces strict building codes, for example, loses far fewer lives than one that does not, because houses and schools remain standing. Regular drills teach residents what to do, and clear communication prevents panic. As a result, hospitals are not overwhelmed, and people receive help sooner. Communities that know their risks and have rescue teams trained in advance are better able to protect their most vulnerable members.

In addition, preparedness reduces economic damage and speeds recovery. Every unit of money spent on preparation can save many times as much on repair, because protected homes, factories and roads suffer less harm and businesses can reopen sooner. Insurance schemes and emergency funds ensure that families are not pushed into poverty. Public confidence also rises when people see that their government is ready, which supports stability and investment. Although preparing requires investment in equipment, training and planning, and some of it may never be used, the cost is small compared with the losses from a major disaster. Coastal countries that built sea walls and warning systems after severe storms, for instance, have been able to protect cities that were once highly vulnerable.

To sum up, disaster preparedness brings clear benefits to a country, above all lives saved and lower economic losses. For these reasons, it deserves sustained public support.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Earthquakes, floods, storms and epidemics** — động đất, lũ, bão và dịch bệnh
- **disaster preparedness** — sự chuẩn bị ứng phó thiên tai
- **protection of lives and health** — bảo vệ tính mạng và sức khoẻ
- **reduced economic damage and faster recovery** — thiệt hại kinh tế thấp hơn và phục hồi nhanh hơn
- **saves lives and reduces injuries** — cứu mạng người và giảm thương tích
- **Early warning systems, evacuation plans** — hệ thống cảnh báo sớm, kế hoạch sơ tán
- **strict building codes** — quy chuẩn xây dựng nghiêm ngặt
- **stored supplies** — vật tư dự trữ
- **communities recover faster** — cộng đồng phục hồi nhanh hơn
- **an earthquake zone** — vùng động đất
- **remain standing** — vẫn đứng vững
- **Regular drills** — các buổi diễn tập thường xuyên
- **prevents panic** — ngăn hoảng loạn
- **hospitals are not overwhelmed** — bệnh viện không bị quá tải
- **rescue teams trained in advance** — đội cứu hộ được đào tạo trước
- **most vulnerable members** — những thành viên dễ tổn thương nhất
- **save many times as much on repair** — tiết kiệm nhiều lần chi phí sửa chữa
- **reopen sooner** — mở cửa lại sớm hơn
- **Insurance schemes and emergency funds** — chương trình bảo hiểm và quỹ khẩn cấp
- **pushed into poverty** — bị đẩy vào nghèo đói
- **Sea walls** — đê biển
- **clear benefits** — lợi ích rõ ràng
- **sustained public support** — sự hỗ trợ công lâu dài